

The right capacity, in the right parts of the function.

Headcount ratios would have called this supply-chain organisation efficient. Assessing workload role by role showed something more useful: a lean structure carrying peer-topping spend per person, with no headroom left for the growth it was being asked to absorb.

| INDUSTRY                       | ENGAGEMENT CONTEXT             | ROLE                                                     | DURATION |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Energy & utilities — regulated | Consulting · US energy utility | Organisational benchmarking & operating-model assessment | 12 weeks |

THE SITUATION

- Leadership needed to know whether the supply-chain organisation was structured to support current spend and planned growth.
- Raw headcount comparisons risked obscuring real differences in role scope, process design and functional coverage between peers.
- The objective was a fact base for workforce and operating-model decisions, not a headcount verdict.

MY CONTRIBUTION

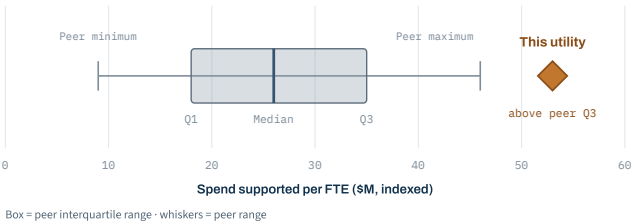
I led the benchmarking assessment across structure, role allocation and functional capacity — defining the peer-comparison framework, assessing spend supported per FTE across the organisation, reviewing coverage across sourcing, procurement operations, PMO/CoE and planning, and translating the findings into executive-level structural implications.

THE JUDGMENT THAT MATTERED

High spend per person can mean a lean organisation or an overloaded one, and the two call for opposite responses. Reading the number alongside scope, service expectations and how execution work was distributed is what turned a benchmark into a recommendation.

EXHIBIT 1 Spend supported per FTE against peer utilities

Peer distribution shown as a box plot · directional

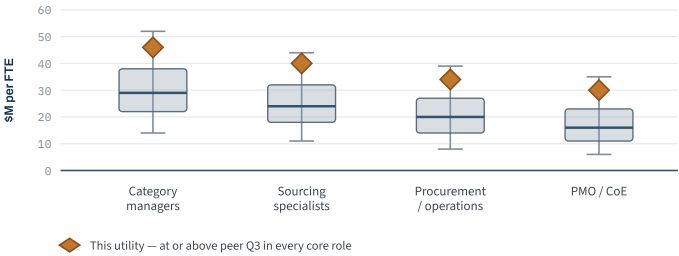


SO WHAT

The utility supports more spend per FTE than the peer range — evidence of a lean, broad-scope structure rather than an over-resourced one.

EXHIBIT 2 Spend supported per FTE, by role

Each box = peer distribution · diamond = this utility · directional



SO WHAT

Every core role sits at or above the peer upper quartile, so spend responsibility is concentrated in manager roles with limited dedicated execution headroom beneath them.

WHAT THE WORK DELIVERED

- A structured fact base on supply-chain sizing relative to peers, usable directly in workforce planning.
- Lean enablement and the absence of a standalone planning function identified as the two structural gaps.
- Visibility into where spend responsibility concentrated across roles and where functional coverage thinned.
- A prioritised reinforcement roadmap: clearer ownership of coordination-heavy work, execution support in procurement operations, incremental PMO/CoE capacity and formal planning capability.

HEADLINE

Role by role

supply-chain capacity assessed